

Learning



- **Define Learning**
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Define Learning

“Learning is the process by which individuals acquire new knowledge, skills, behaviors, or attitudes through experience, practice, or study. It involves the modification of existing knowledge and can occur in various contexts and environments”.

Learning is based on observation of behavior changes that result from a person's interaction with their environment. An individual's learning may involve changes in any of three areas: Manner of perceiving and thinking. Physical behavior (motor skills). Emotional reactions or attitudes.

Learning can be defined in many ways, but most psychologists would agree that it is a relatively permanent change in behavior that results from experience.

1. Law of Readiness:

Individuals learn best when they are ready and motivated to learn. If a learner is not prepared, the learning process may be hindered.

2. Law of Exercise:

Repetition strengthens learning. The more frequently a behavior is practiced, the more likely it is to be retained.

3. Law of Effect:

Responses followed by satisfying outcomes are more likely to be repeated, while those followed by unpleasant outcomes are less likely to be repeated.

4. Law of Primacy:

Information learned first is often remembered better than information learned later.

5. Law of Recency:

The most recently learned information is often remembered best.

1. Operant Conditioning

Definition: A type of learning in which behavior is modified by its consequences. Reinforcements increase the likelihood of a behavior, while punishments decrease it.

Key Concepts:

Reinforcement: Strengthens behavior (positive reinforcement adds a pleasant stimulus, while negative reinforcement removes an unpleasant stimulus).

Punishment: Weakens behavior (positive punishment adds an unpleasant stimulus, while **negative punishment removes a pleasant stimulus**).

Example: A child receives praise (positive reinforcement) for completing homework, increasing the likelihood of them doing it again.

2. Classical Conditioning:

Definition: A learning process in which a neutral stimulus becomes associated with a meaningful stimulus, leading to a learned response.

Key Concepts:

Unconditioned Stimulus (US): A stimulus that naturally triggers a response (e.g., food).

Unconditioned Response (UR): The natural response to the unconditioned stimulus (e.g., salivation).

Conditioned Stimulus (CS): A previously neutral stimulus that, after association with the unconditioned stimulus, triggers a conditioned response (e.g., a bell).

Conditioned Response (CR): The learned response to the conditioned stimulus (e.g., salivating at the sound of the bell).

Example: Pavlov's dogs learned to salivate (CR) at the sound of a bell (CS) after it was repeatedly paired with food (US).